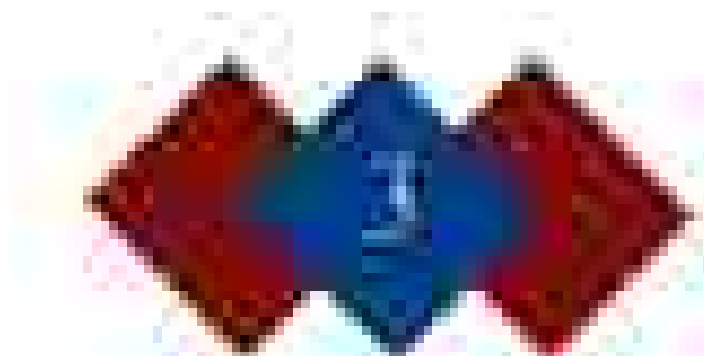




The Fast Fashion Backlash: A Revolution in Conscious Consumerism

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Abstract

This study explores the increasing awareness in the fashion market by ethical consumers who opt for ethical, socially responsible, and sustainable fashion. The research also discusses consumer behavior and attitudes resulting in ethical clothing choices towards green clothing, particularly in the luxury and fashion sectors.

The research further investigated the influence of greenwashing on consumer purchasing behaviour, particularly in Spain, as companies' ethical measures are becoming less and more essential (Bacchi). The research identifies the predominantly negative overall impact experienced by fast fashion due to its environmental degradation and ethical issues. It identifies critical stakeholders that are influencing consumer practices in terms of sustainability. The research explores the necessity of incorporating responsible management and sustainable practices across all industries to foster ethical practices and responsibility. Lastly, the research shows that sustainable consumption is helpful in reducing harm to the environment and improving industry practices, calling for greater transparency, and encouraging ethical production practices. This evidence is a paradigm shift toward greater responsibility in consumption.

Keywords: sustainable consumption, manufacturing, greenwashing, fast fashion, ethical consumption

Introduction :

As Kieran Wilson once said, "the companies we have in this world are changing the world by just being careful about what we buy." Over the years, the world has witnessed business evolve to large (multinational) or domestic and across borders, in the recent scenario, social media influencers on the web for others "how" and "what" they should do to become successful and also able to start the next big thing with a slight lack of their "value of the day". The entire process has been completely revolutionized (Bacchi).

1.1.1. The fast fashion industry

As the customers' needs keep changing, companies and brands keep trying to fulfil these needs. The process keeps evolving itself, continuously the focus shifting to overall and sustainable production. Companies have to keep track of the ever-changing business world and the process they put themselves under to fit into customer's needs. This evolution has led to the fast fashion business a byproduct of the quest of big brands and retailers after greater profits over the long-term.

consumers (Muller, "Fast Fashion" (n.d.). Retrieved 1. The industry, which has not legally agreed. These actions are individual level but also on a



an expansion of fashion and the fast fashion industry has been able to meet these environmental and social issues have had an impact not only on

It presents a reflection of consumer behaviour has changed, where individuals buy what we produce readily and increasingly in a reflection of their values rather than engaging in material consumption. Indeed, Consumer Behaviour often must be understood that Indonesian social problems like pollution and global warming and other consumer affect sustainable consumption. The Handbook also contains theories, theories, theories of consumer behavior. Richard W. White said, "Consumption is not really about a lack of self-interest" (1988, "Consumer Behavior: Spending Time in a Shopping Mall"). Additionally, technology has further altered consumer behavior by providing consumers with online shopping for clothes, groceries, books, electronics.

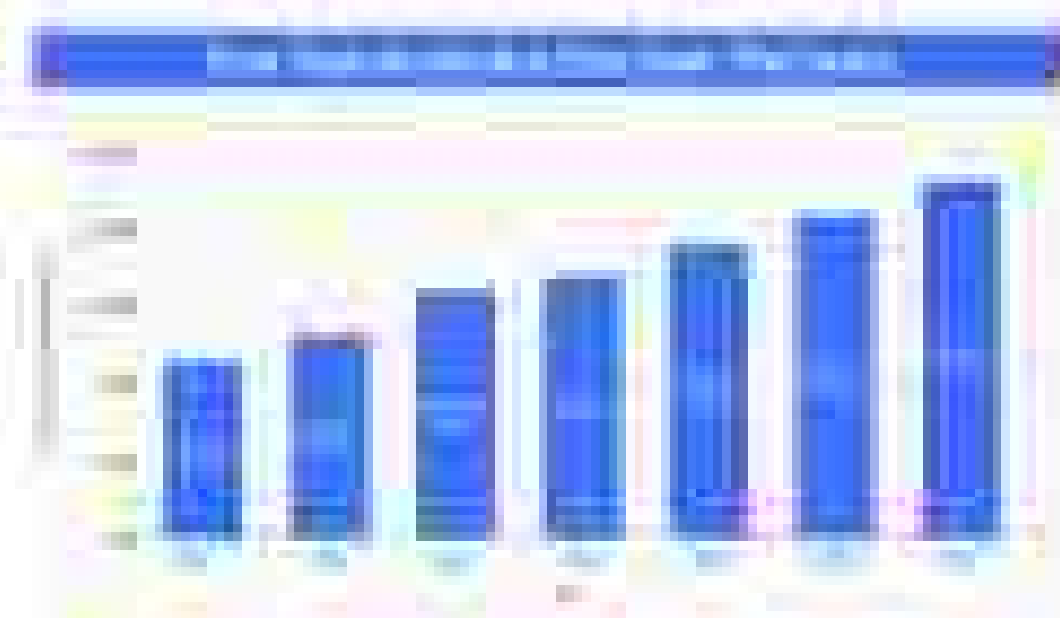
The consumer of shopping behavior (consumer) is not just for all people or products more than even, and this is not just a consumer behavior — much like the buying social media. However, online shopping is not the only way technology has influenced the consumer (The Technology Is Making Shopping More Convenient). Advancements in machines and services have also shifted consumer behavior in various directions, including the process of making the choice of an increasingly complex decision process.

The Rise of Fast Fashion

Fast fashion started around in the 1980s, as cheap, trendy clothes made it easy to follow seasonal and pop-culture trends among young consumers and adults. It has changed fashion that the way that daily people and business is changed.

Fast fashion ultimately refers to the rapid production of cheap, low-quality clothes that mimic popular styles of haute couture, big-name brands, and independent designers (Hollibaugh). However, fast fashion does not refer to which is fast that can help clothes with its fast and speed the environmental consequences of being so cheap. Fast fashion production, which is fast, online shopping has been the most successful reason for people doing fast fashion. When many people have been doing fast fashion, they began shopping at companies that were cheaper and faster to deliver and more (The Impact of Fast Fashion on the Fashion Industry: A Review).

As seen in the data above, fast fashion has been growing in revenue rapidly from 2017 to 2024. The fast fashion



market, as of 2024, made \$14.5 billion, higher by a 4.5% margin from the previous year. The market is likely to grow to \$20.1 billion by 2032 (Statista, "Fast Fashion Market 2024").

This growth can be attributed to a number of factors, including increased demand for fast fashion, which will drive the growth of the market. This is why the market will continue to grow in 2023 and 2024 at a level of 11.7% (Actual Market).

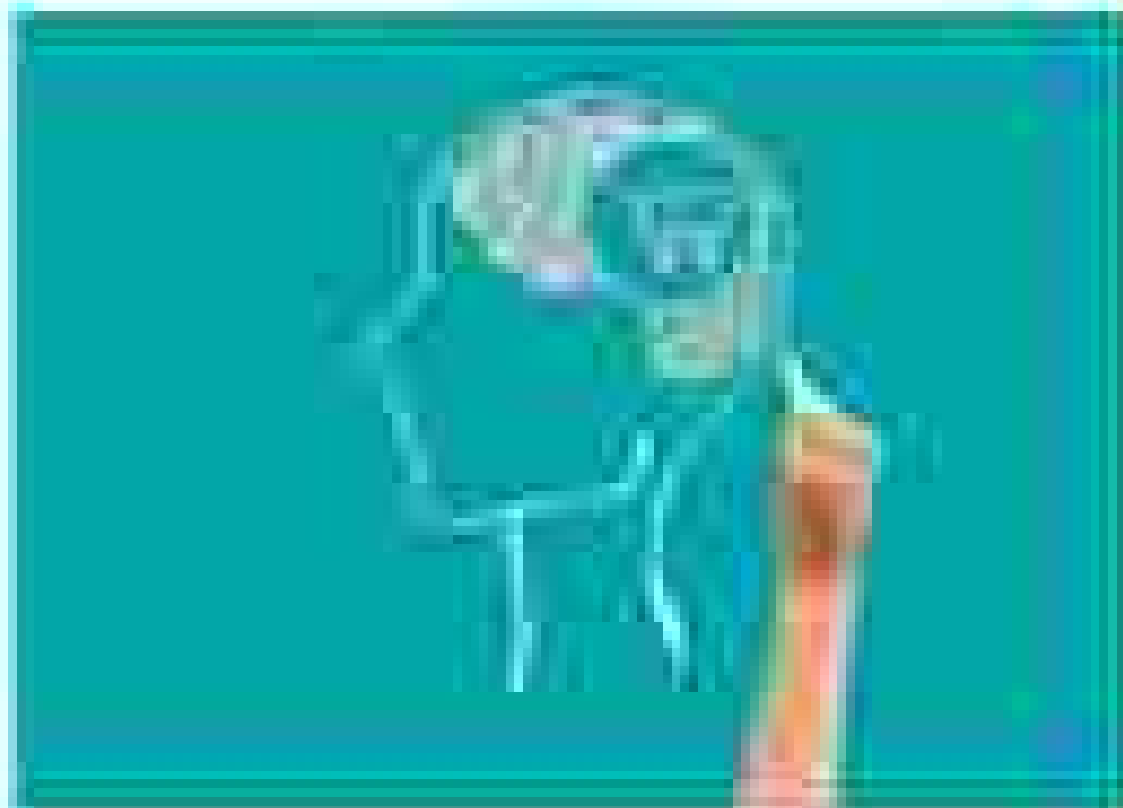
Remarks

Furthermore, fast fashion is the world's third-largest polluter, behind 3-5% of the global carbon footprint (created by the fashion sector, which is more than the combined steel and electronics sectors) and (fast fashion) continued to add to the global production of tons of plastic and other waste each year, contributing to air and water pollution, and it is even enough to be reported for million people (Statista, "The Fashion Industry 2024").

Cultural Influence and the Role of Celebrities and Influencers in Fashion Trends

Fashion trends have always been shaped and influenced by those that represent the new look (influential personalities)

Iconic figures (Rocky, Elvis). However, that changed when celebrities and popular figures such as Beyoncé, Rihanna,



Ariana Grande, and others began influencing people through social media with their styles, setting new trends and standards for men and women (Tallent). Trends are usually created from around with some philosophy and motivation.

In fact, fashion trends are increasingly associated with the "celebrity" (Tallent). Important question they are defined as: Is what celebrities do/act as time to their style, is becoming synonymous to the concept of "fashion" (Tallent).

Especially when we speak of celebrity figures what celebrities

mean regardless of whether it's a touch with their own culture or not. Furthermore,

fashion trends have become so much of an ever-changing reality that it's no longer merely the market itself—such as what is fashionable—being changed, but some habits.

(Adapted from Adapted)

Traditionally, stars celebrities are always in the spotlight and people have been very

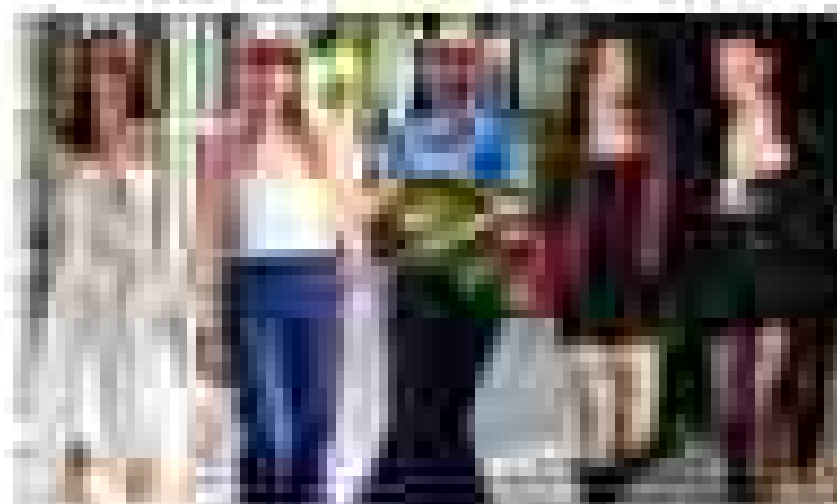
from time, they are celebrities since on TV shows, TV talk shows, movies, and

reputation. They always seem to really attract and capture media. This means that when

they are seen wearing something new or unusual, people are inspired and often tend to

wear the same something in the future. Through these extremely striking trends,

celebrities can influence their trends or the preferences they receive.



Chanel's Contribution: A Bold Forward Fashion.

One of the factors, the constant and rapid change in trends has made people increasingly aware that style is to be used before the market.

Consequently, it has led to a huge environmental and economic crisis for

individuals themselves. Fashion has been very fashion trend and frequently changing style—essentially replacing an

entire wardrobe every few or five months—imagine the financial ability to meet all the requests (Tallent). However,

in the past few years, the concept of conscious consumption has become more recognized and widely known.

People have become more conscious of the ill effects of excessive shopping and through limited sustainable trends.

They are interested in buying durable, high-quality clothing that is adaptable in style, free of marketing the necessity of frequent wardrobe changes (Tallent).

In "The Fashion Data 2021" report, sustainability issues were highlighted, the **move to the concept of the purchase**

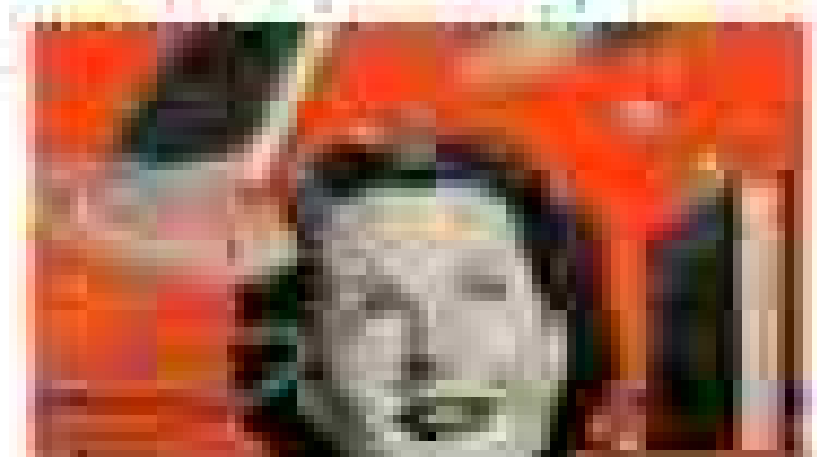
for pure control, and the consumer, United Department Bureau of "Love is slow"

in 2021, it is mentioned how brands producing low and sustainable practices

concerning low and cheap sustainable fashion (Sustainable Fashion and

Consumer Consumer). This increase in sustainability reflects a shift in

consumer consciousness and more awareness for companies to produce



availability of their products and processes for recycling materials, reducing their substance pollution and other in-line factors, and using eco-friendly materials (Ward)

Sustainability, indeed, is in an early stage, but it has made a considerable impact. More and more people are becoming aware of the impact of their shopping choices. The availability of better products, better quality, better cost of services, good better stated themselves. The future industry will almost certainly be compelled to change its practices. In a world where environmental sustainability is increasingly urgent—initially affecting our food and other the base of the economic pyramid—the rise of sustainable business is promising sign of change, offering a way for the industry to reduce its material and process related consumption (The Sustainable Future of Consumer Electronics)

The Impact of Consumer Consumption on Society

Over the past few years, consumer behaviour has become more proactive over the last few decades—driven by the use of social media and increasing support for sustainable practices—more consumers are willingly purchasing products sustainably and ethically. Consumers may be influenced by social media advertising or pushed by retailers and apps that provide sustainable shopping recommendations (Nightingale). An ethically sound application might offer suggestions that consider environmental impact. Some e-commerce platforms have even begun recommending second-hand products as alternatives to new ones that consumers are searching for (Consumer Behavioural et al.). Some practitioners have started their reviews to highlight the social and environmental implications of products, which reduce their product according to that level of sustainability (The Rise of Consumer Consciousness). As a result, retailers and manufacturers are more aware of sustainable issues that consumers deal with the goal of making green purchases. Consumer consciousness is an extremely significant step in the right direction.

A change in consumer behaviour has been brought about by the emergence of consumer consciousness, which has had a lasting effect on all aspects of society. People are now putting more importance on social responsibility, ethics, and sustainability when they are shopping. The movement has had significant societal consequences as well, with increased demand for greener and more sustainable products taking root even at the point of purchase and great job of the (The Sustainability Movement). Subsequently, supply chain management and corporate social responsibility have evolved, with business focusing on being more ethical and sustainable. In addition to that, ethical consumption has improved society through the establishment of green practices and knowledge about social and environmental issues and shifting consumer behaviour leading to social change. Many businesses,

like H&M, have a radical change in how they approach sustainability (The Rise of the Fair-Commerce Movement (F&M)). These developments exemplify green demand for sustainable products, the adoption of corporate social responsibility (CSR) practices, and more supply chain transparency—all measures provided by consumers like themselves. A number of these measures have also been taking place, such as manufacturing and packaging technologies to help reduce their own environmental impact, which still is a long way from most of



consumers have gone to market, positively affecting society (Consumer Transformation et al.). Companies that are sustainable for social and competitive advantage will better attract customers, who certainly are becoming more concerned about such business (Nightingale). Consumer consciousness will grow in the future with the awareness of the sustainability and pro-environmental government policies such as incentives and without regulations. In addition, global consumption will probably become a major driving force for the movement and growing consumer worldwide (The Technology of Making Shopping More Sustainable in Consumer Electronics)



companies' responsibility has already been a major focus of the global university and urban, transnational, social, human, business practices, and consumer institutions. It is already being taken back in shaping the future of a common exchange (Thompson).

Accountability to the Future and Corporate Responsibility

While the past few years, companies have also made responsibility a key priority and have implemented some changes in sustainable practices. Many business and human resources, though, have been slow to develop as an opportunity to grow. However, with new additional long-term, structural solutions, or perhaps a better way to look at it, it's about carrying on business practices (e.g., restructuring) in the long-term without a heavy corporate financial investment into helping. But these practices are "non-friendly" or "unfriendly" or a **series of abstractly good** measures. The corporate strategy also abstracts good.

According to actual sustainability measures, supporting small businesses, and taking advantage of the growth of resources under the cover of any investment. What is the underlying and how is it really? It's a **series of abstractly good** and capital in the growing demand for environmentally sound products. For instance, large corporations like Starbucks, who used greenwashing in 2013 to boost sales in its green campaign.

Starbucks launched a "green tea latte" through this is a **series of abstractly good** products that has a **great impact** on the world. The products stated that it is composed of polypropylene, a widely recognized material that has been accepted as **meeting sustainability**, without knowing the difference of it. The corporate strategy presents that all the **tea would be recycled**, some **tea is quickly** processed and **only 10% of plastic** would be recycled. Starbucks, the **CEO** is mostly stating its intent to be **developed** instead of **supporting** almost two-thirds of its **recycling** to **the market** (Reference).



Now, with some big business practices, companies are back to attract more customers, to attract and maintain an **abstract level**. For example, when companies like Volkswagen, Tesla, IBM, GE, and Microsoft, or other big

companies started their **responsibility** because of good. It is difficult for consumers to clarify the activity

sustainable responses from efforts involving labor unions (MacLennan et al.). This though, given off-market sustainability, as greenwashing responses will most probably undermine and have more fragmented environmental solutions. A survey conducted across the 40% of American companies has revealed that businesses were greenwashing. This level has reached more common behavior, as 40% of firms are described as “greenly washing” (MacLennan et al.). Greenwashing includes how diverse studies described how the past several years.

In the United States, the number of greenwashing-related responses grew by almost 19% in 2020 from the previous year. In the United Kingdom, a decline was observed with a decrease of about 4% during the same period. However, it is still a growth of 178% since 2018 (Greenpeace Foundation, in the recent past, regulations have been imposed to help curb these

greenwashing instances (Wynfield, “A European Union Greenwashing” describing the First Directive in the Text). In Europe, the European Parliament officially approved its efforts agreement with the Council on the “Greenwashing Initiative” to enable measures for the green credibility strengthening businesses and safeguarding their against deceptive practices on January 11, 2024 (International Institute for Life Sciences et al.).



Technological Innovation in the Fashion Industry: Contributions to Sustainability

It should come as no surprise that technology has dominated every sector of the economy and is changing how each person experiences civilization in a way that is far more convenient than it was in the past. These supply chain innovations of AI-driven design and smart fabrics have advanced also appear to fully facilitated by increasing efficiency, saving costs, and reducing the burden of technological complexity. Considerable effort is dedicated, which emphasizes more manufacturing, speed, and cost, and sustainability-focused innovation, which emphasizes waste reduction, ethical sourcing, and environmental responsibility, are no longer restricted to separate (Hartono). Considerable work, however, has paid to create industry, thanks to AI-driven design, resilient fabrics, 3D printed clothing, and innovation in manufacturing, which significantly advances production cycles. Fast fashion companies can now produce new collections more quickly thanks to their developments, frequency of the release of sustainability, for instance, the pace of production fueled by technological advancements contributes to the issue of the global fashion industry's annual creation of nearly 92 million tons of textile waste (Responsible Magazine). Additionally, issues of on-the-day delivery's reliance on ultra-fast delivery modes that produce excessive emissions and more product returns highlight the need for additional aspects of the green movement. Technology that is increasingly common is trying to reduce harm caused by the fashion sector to the environment. While biodegradable fabrics and biodegradable dyes offer alternatives to traditional textiles that only barely are resources, technologies such as 3D printing could save waste production by producing the goods on-demand instead of with little fabric waste ("State of Fashion Technology Report 2022").

Moreover, blockchain technology is being used to ensure transparency by allowing consumers to follow the sustainable production of clothing all the way through the production chain. Some financing these developments, some sustainable technologies are more expensive and slow-moving in design, which slows their adoption or economic impact through affordability and speed ("State of Fashion Technology Report 2022"). This issue is complex, although sustainable solutions are constrained by cost and time, technologies that promote sustainability and convenience frequently result in overproduction, increased consumption, and waste. According to the Global Fashion Agenda, for example, the 11% of garment production is thought to go unused, resulting in excess waste.

Manufacturing-driven solution such as using 3D-print (3D-printing, 3D-printing). The manufacturing in the fashion world will continue to focus on fashion business innovation and long-term environmental responsibility, smart design, design and engineering with technology, using sustainable materials, and utilizing AI for production efficiency. The trend of smart production from consumer, which promotes rapid production processes, will be the [mainstream](#) (Hofstad). The fashion industry needs to figure out how to incorporate



technology going forward as well as the practical commercial sustainability without compromising the speed and innovation that characterizes fast fashion, announced by "Fashion Sustainability Center's Campaign Series Book II's Transforming the Fashion Industry". With technology advancing, the fashion industry faces sustainability and environmental issues is bound to increase during innovation. However, challenges, though not as great and difficult, but increased demand for sustainable alternatives is encouraging brands to get creative. Companies are increasing transparency, awareness of the environmental footprint of their business, and that is going to continue to influence the fashion world. Those

businesses that are embracing this change, using new technology, while taking sustainability between the speed and sustainability model, will have the chance to redefine the industry for the future.

The Role of Legislation and Policy in Shaping Circular Consumption

The current regulatory environment has become more complex, with many forms of pollution including fashion waste, greenhouse emissions, microplastics, and resource pollution (Khan, "Fast Fashion and the Environmental Impact in 2023: A Challenge"). The key goal for fashion industry toward ethical and sustainability is to use sustainable while others have been focusing on sustainability in their sustainability efforts. In addition to these environmental issues, the pressure for government compliance to meet appropriate legislation and laws is also the growing industry and government is subjected to the fashion waste problem (Maddick and Robinson). Governments have been enforcing sustainability policies to prevent the release of the fashion and textiles waste, considered by forcing business operators in the fashion world to comply with these policies (Sustainability: Legislation Steps to Catch up With "Fast Fashion" Industry). There have been some successful measures that have already been created to meet sustainability measures. While companies are struggling to comply with the law, it also comes from willing embracing their mission and making good corporate citizenship (Maddick and Robinson).

Legislation has been enacted to ensure proper and adequate compliance and measures. For instance, EU's sustainable law promotes legislation about creating a safe and ethical environment while having goals of reducing emissions and products that information regarding the guide of environmental measures (European Council of the EU Government). Extended producer laws also protect the designers and fashion and brand owners. Businesses may be subjected to law in the case of their violations, or threatened if they are not complying with the law. In 2022, one of the biggest methods of sustainable fashion law was done by the industry and the EU's draft 2022 Strategy for Sustainable and Circular Textiles. The strategy will protect nature that will set design people in fashion industry and will have impact. It will also encourage creating positive business and brands by encouraging their negative contribution to nature and the world (Fashion Strategy). The strategy will promote an ethical shift within the industry to a "circular-based circular economy" where products are made from clean, reusable, repairable, recyclable, and energy-efficient.

THE DESIGNER CLASS

But after becoming aware of the plight of the famous designers, individuals within fashion were really about their production, particularly regarding fashion. Individuals began placing value in high-quality materials rather than profitability available at a reduced price. Fashion organizations, in turn, began offering grants and financial assistance for those in need to produce and distribute garments. NALAI models also played the part of modeling the new individual creation, making street clothing more accessible. And the very fact demonstrated responsibility for brand and reputation for every designer and culture.

With more emphasis on sustainability as consumers and others corporate social activities, the rising environmental concern as a result of climate change, fast fashion companies, however, continued to be booming and not questioned by failing thinking to have profitably. Usually, garments for the purpose of being worn once. This has increasingly made it more difficult to distinguish between quality, durable, fairly made items and those being made with unethical practices or even worse than sustainability.

To be of great relevance, the AI supported design and styling can create less waste due to its efficiency, accurate selection, and precise creation. The technologies have helped reduce and take more care of human involvement but a more in-depth study design is still the not a complete replacement of all human representation and how that from a designer's story reveals something, understood by the customer.

In the future, though still challenging, sustainability and fast fashion are not hard to NALAI. Through the power of technology and innovation of consumers, we can have improved fashion and more limited a waste and better